

MSMEs become globally competitive?

A: MSMEs are the foundation of Gujarat's industrial growth. With more than 4.2 million MSMEs, our strategy centres on improving access to technology, finance, quality certification, market linkages, exports and digital transformation, while promoting Industry 4.0 and AI adoption.

Through initiatives such as Udyami Mela, capacity-building workshops, AI demonstrations and Reverse Buyer Seller Meets, MSMEs have gained greater technology exposure and direct access to global markets. More than 10,800 B2B meetings generated export business enquiries worth over ₹1,680 crore.

The Viksit Gujarat Industrial Policy 2026 further strengthens this ecosystem through targeted support for MSMEs, start-ups, women entrepreneurs and first-generation industrialists.

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Q: India has set an ambitious goal of becoming a developed nation by 2047. What role do you see Gujarat playing in achieving that vision?

A: Gujarat is a committed partner in India's journey towards Viksit Bharat@2047. States will be the real engines of India's economic transformation, as land, infrastructure, skilling, local governance and investor facilitation are largely driven at the state level.

Gujarat aims to contribute through leadership in manufacturing, exports, ports and logistics, financial services, renewable energy, innovation and inclusive regional development.

Q: Several states are now offering incentives to attract industries. Does Gujarat still believe incentives are the biggest differentiator, or has governance become the real advantage?

A: Financial incentives may attract initial interest, but governance is what ultimately drives investment decisions. Today, investors place equal, if not greater, importance on policy stability, regulatory transparency, speed of approvals, quality infrastructure, land availability and post-investment support. Gujarat's experience has consistently shown that responsive and predictable governance creates a far stronger competitive advantage than incentives alone.

This is reflected in our single-window clearance system, time-bound approvals, efficient project monitoring and strong inter-departmental coordination. By developing plug-and-play industrial infrastructure, sector-specific industrial parks and ready utility networks, we have significantly reduced project implementation timelines.

Our track record speaks for itself. The Micron semiconductor project progressed from the signing of the Memorandum of Understanding to groundbreaking within just three months. Going forward, we will further strengthen this ecosystem through data-driven decision-making, AI-enabled project monitoring and deeper industry engagement.

Q: Gujarat has recently launched the Viksit Gujarat Industrial Policy 2026 and the Viksit Gujarat Data Centre Policy. How do you see these helping the state maintain its current position?

A: These will strengthen Gujarat's leadership while positioning the state as a global destination for advanced manufacturing, innovation and the digital economy. Together, they mark the next phase of Gujarat's growth journey—from India's manufacturing leader to a global hub for the industries of the future.

The Industrial Policy introduces a more flexible and industry-centric approach. Through the “Choose Your Incentive” framework, industries can opt for a customised combination of capital subsidy, interest subsidy or power tariff reimbursement based on their business requirements. The policy focuses on 21 thrust sectors while promoting R&D, innovation, value addition and high-quality employment. It also supports women entrepreneurs and first-generation industrialists through targeted incentives, skill development and enhanced support mechanisms. Complementing this, the Data Centre Policy targets investments of up to ₹6 lakh crore and 7.5 GW of data centre capacity. **BT**

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